



THE CLARITY DIAGNOSTIC

The Work Is There. The Proof Isn't Keeping Up.

5 findings. The fixes. In order of impact.

Stoney Trail Dental — East Hills | Calgary SE, AB

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I spent some time with Stoney Trail Dental's digital footprint this week. Here's what stood out.

Stoney Trail Dental is doing a lot of things right. You're open seven days a week — including Sundays, when most of your competitors are dark. You have a 4.9-star rating across nearly 300 reviews, which tells me patients are having a genuinely good experience. You've built a comprehensive service mix — implants, Invisalign, Botox, laser dentistry, TMJ — that most single-location practices can't match. And you have an award-winning dentist on staff: Dr. Sameet Gill was named Dentist of the Year in Canada and Young Dentist of the Year globally at the 2024 Forttuna Global Excellence Awards.

You have a 4.9-star rating and a globally recognized dentist. The problem isn't what's happening inside the practice. The problem is that not enough people outside it know yet.

The central issue is this: Galaxy Dental is operating in the same East Hills commercial area. They have 3,078 Google reviews to your approximately 300. That 10:1 gap drives Maps pack dominance — which means that when someone in your neighborhood searches for a dentist, an implant specialist, or an Invisalign provider, Galaxy Dental appears first. You don't appear at all. The quality you've built isn't in question. What's lagging is the system that turns satisfied patients into visible public proof — and without that, Galaxy compounds their lead every single month.

10:1

REVIEW GAP, SAME NEIGHBORHOOD

Galaxy Dental: 3,078 reviews · Stoney Trail Dental: ~300 reviews

This diagnostic identifies five specific gaps and tells you exactly how to close them.

How I See This

There's a pattern I've seen across dental practices in competitive urban markets, and Stoney Trail fits it almost exactly.

The clinical side is strong. You've got the team, the credentials, the service range, and the patient satisfaction to prove it. The problem isn't that patients are leaving unhappy — they're not. The problem is what happens after they leave. The average satisfied patient doesn't leave a Google review. They go home, tell a family member the appointment was fine, and that's the end of it. Meanwhile, the practice up the road — Galaxy Dental — has systematized the ask. They've built a pipeline that converts satisfied patient moments into posted reviews at a rate that's accumulated 3,000+ signals of social proof. Every one of those reviews tells Google: this practice is active, trusted, and relevant. Google responds by ranking them above everything else in the Maps pack.

Every satisfied patient who leaves without leaving a review is a marketing opportunity that compounds in someone else's favor.

The review gap is the headline, but it's not the only issue. The booking flow requires a staff callback — which means a patient who finds you on a Sunday evening (when you're the only practice in your area that's open the next morning) still can't book online. The content engine has been quiet since approximately 2021. And Dr. Gill's Forttuna award — a specific, verifiable, globally recognized credential — is sitting in a doctor bio page instead of being featured where it belongs: in the homepage hero, in the GBP description, in the conversation with every prospective patient evaluating whether to call.

Stoney Trail is open Sundays. Galaxy Dental is not. That's a genuine, searchable competitive advantage — but it only works if it's visible. Right now, it's not prominently positioned anywhere new patients would see it.

None of these are structural problems. Each one is fixable. The sequencing matters: fix the review system first, because that moves the Maps ranking, which moves the traffic, which makes every other fix more valuable.

1 No Active Review Solicitation System — and the Infrastructure to Fix It Already Exists

You have a dedicated page at stoneytraildental.ca/write-a-review/ and a feedback subdirectory beneath it. Someone on your team thought about this at some point. The outcome — approximately 300 reviews

after years of 4.9-star patient care — tells me the page exists, but patients aren't being systematically directed there after every visit.

| *The page exists. The pipeline doesn't.*

WHY THIS MATTERS

~3 reviews/month

ESTIMATED CURRENT VELOCITY

Standard for a healthy single-location practice is 8–15 per month

Google's Maps algorithm treats review velocity as a freshness signal. A practice generating 3 reviews per month looks stagnant. A practice generating 12 per month looks like it's busy and trusted. Galaxy Dental didn't accumulate 3,078 reviews by accident — they built a system. The gap between you and them doesn't close by itself; it only narrows through a consistent, automated ask.

HERE'S WHAT I'D DO

Step 1 — Set up an automated post-appointment text/email (1–2 hours): Most practice management systems (Dentrix, Carestream, Jane App) have a patient communication module that can fire a text message or email 2–4 hours after an appointment. The message should be simple: "Thanks for coming in today — if you have a moment, a Google review would mean a lot to us." Include a direct link to your Google review page. No multi-step form. One link, one action.

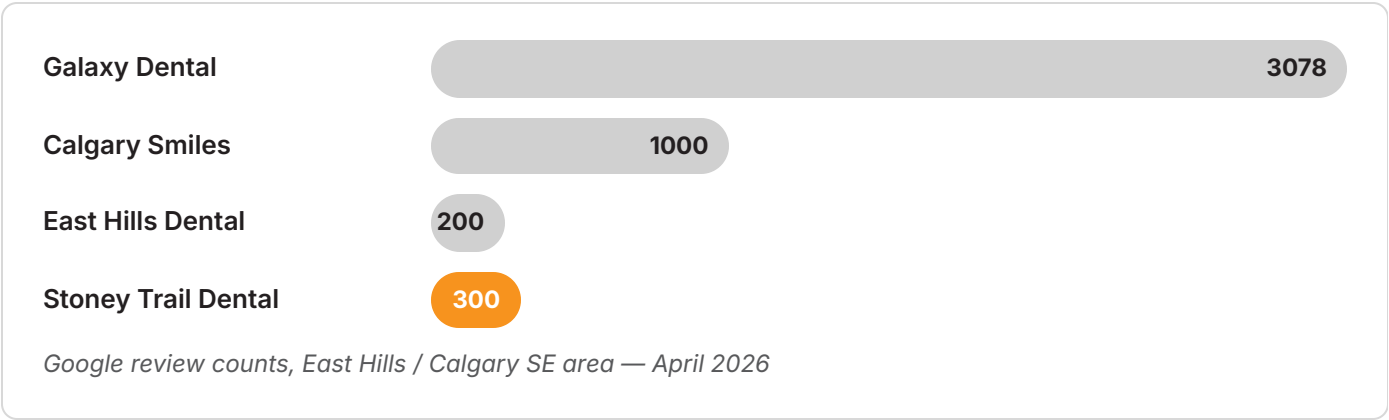
Step 2 — Add the /write-a-review/ page link to appointment confirmation emails: Patients who confirm an appointment are in a positive frame. Put the review link in the confirmation and in the post-visit follow-up. You don't need to ask twice — but you do need to ask once, clearly.

Step 3 — Designate a weekly review check: Someone on your team should glance at the review dashboard every Monday. New reviews should get a personalized response within 48 hours. This signals to Google that the profile is actively managed — and signals to prospective patients that you read and care about feedback.

Effort: Quick win

2 Galaxy Dental Is Capturing the Maps Pack — in Your Own Neighborhood

Galaxy Dental is at 250 East Hills Square SE. You're at 185 East Hills Blvd SE. You offer the same services — implants, Invisalign, cosmetic dentistry, general care. You have the same 4.9-star quality rating. The only variable Google's algorithm acts on: their review count is 3,078. Yours is approximately 300.



WHY THIS MATTERS

— Not shown

Estimated Maps pack for 'Calgary SE dentist' — Stoney Trail absent from top 3 organic results

0 of 5

ESTIMATED MAPS PACK PRESENCE

Primary Calgary SE searches: "SE dentist," "SE family dentist," "SE implants," "SE cosmetic dentist," "SE Invisalign"

When someone moves into the East Hills neighborhood and Googles "dentist near me" or "Calgary SE dental implants," they see the top 3 results. Galaxy Dental is almost certainly in that top 3. You're not. The patient doesn't know you exist. They call Galaxy, not because Galaxy is better, but because Google showed them Galaxy first. The Maps pack isn't a popularity contest — it's an algorithm. And right now, the algorithm is working against you.

HERE'S WHAT I'D DO

The fix for this finding is the same as Finding 1, because Finding 1 is the root cause. Fix the review solicitation system, and you begin closing the volume gap. There are two parallel steps to take that



accelerate the timeline:

GBP category audit (30 minutes): Log into your Google Business Profile and confirm you have service-specific categories added beyond the generic "Dentist" category. You should have: "Cosmetic Dentist," "Dental Implants Provider," and "Invisalign Provider" as additional categories. Each service-specific category makes you eligible to appear in that specific Maps search. A practice with 300 reviews and the right service category can outrank a practice with 500 reviews and a generic category.

GBP description update (30 minutes): Your GBP description should lead with your differentiators — specifically "Open 7 days including Sundays," "Award-winning team," and the high-margin services (implants, Invisalign, cosmetic). This isn't about keyword stuffing; it's about communicating the same things prospective patients actually search for.

Effort: Medium (category fix is quick; review volume closes over 3–6 months with consistent solicitation)

3 Dr. Gill's Global Award Is the Most Valuable Asset You're Not Using

In 2024, Dr. Sameet Gill was named Dentist of the Year in Canada and Young Dentist of the Year globally at the Forttuna Global Excellence Awards. That's a specific credential. It's verifiable. And it's the kind of claim that most practices — including Galaxy Dental — cannot make.

It's currently in a doctor bio page.

When a patient is choosing between two 4.9-star dental practices in the same neighborhood, a globally recognized award is not a footnote. It's the reason to call.

WHY THIS MATTERS

1 in how many?

AWARD OF THIS CALIBER

There is no equivalent claim available to any direct competitor in this market

Trust is built in layers. A prospective patient finds you in Google. They check your reviews. They look at your team. Most of that process takes under 90 seconds. If, at any point in that 90 seconds, they see

"our lead dentist was recognized as Canada's best in 2024 by an international jury," the trust level shifts immediately. It reframes the entire evaluation.

HERE'S WHAT I'D DO

Homepage hero update (1–2 hours): Add a one-line trust statement beneath the headline or above the CTA button: "Home to Canada's Dentist of the Year, 2024 Forttuna Global Excellence Awards." Don't bury it in a paragraph — give it its own line.

GBP description update (30 minutes): Lead the GBP description with this credential. The GBP description appears in the knowledge panel when someone searches for the practice directly. It's one of the first text elements they read.

Social content (ongoing): This award should be in your Instagram bio. It should have been a post series. The anniversary of the award, Dr. Gill's personal story — these are human-interest posts that perform well and generate genuine reach, not just follower counts.

Effort: Quick win

4 Your 7-Day Hours Don't Convert After Hours — Because Booking Requires a Callback

Your appointment page is a request form. A patient submits their name and preferred time, and someone on your team follows up. That's standard for a lot of practices — but it creates a specific problem for a practice that's open 7 days, including Sundays.

Being open Sunday means nothing to the patient who searched at 9 PM Saturday and booked somewhere else by morning.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Sunday

GALAXY DENTAL IS CLOSED

You're open 9 AM–5 PM. That gap only converts if patients can book when they find you.

Dental searches spike in the evenings and on weekends — exactly the hours your staff isn't available to respond to a form submission. A patient who Googles "dentist open Sunday Calgary SE" on Saturday night, finds you, and discovers they can't actually book until someone calls them back on Monday morning has effectively not found what they were looking for. If a competitor has a real-time booking button and you don't, the competitor wins the booking even if they're less convenient.

HERE'S WHAT I'D DO

Evaluate Jane App or a similar Canadian-native scheduling platform: Jane App is widely used in Alberta health practices and integrates cleanly with most practice management systems. It provides real-time booking, appointment reminders, and new patient intake forms. The setup investment is typically 1–2 weeks.

Feature Sunday booking explicitly: Once real-time booking is live, add a homepage callout — "Book your Sunday appointment" — with a direct link. Optimize for the search term "dentist open Sunday Calgary SE" with a dedicated landing page or at minimum a meta description update. This converts your operational advantage into a marketing advantage.

Effort: Medium

5 The Content Engine Has Been Quiet — and It's Costing You Organic Ground

The blog at stoneytraildental.ca/blog/ has been dormant since approximately 2021. The Instagram account has 427 followers after 117 posts — which is a low ratio suggesting either sporadic activity or content that isn't compounding reach. No newsletter capture or email list mechanism is visible on the website.

A quiet blog doesn't lose you patients today. But it slowly stops finding them for you tomorrow.

WHY THIS MATTERS

~3–4 years

ESTIMATED BLOG DORMANCY

Each dormant year reduces the practice's organic search authority relative to competitors publishing consistently

Content does three things in a dental marketing context: it signals to Google that the site is active (SEO health), it gives prospective patients a reason to trust before they call (authority building), and it keeps existing patients engaged between visits (retention). A blog post on "what to expect from dental implants in Calgary" ranks for long-tail searches. A GBP post on "open Sundays" captures a specific patient need. An Instagram post on Dr. Gill's award builds trust with followers. None of these require large production budgets — they require consistency.

HERE'S WHAT I'D DO

Establish a monthly cadence, not an ambitious one: One blog post per month is enough to restart Google's freshness signals. Prioritize topics tied to high-margin services: dental implants, Invisalign, Botox, sleep apnea. Each post should include a Calgary SE location signal and a clear CTA ("Book a consultation at Stoney Trail Dental").

Restart GBP posts weekly: GBP posts are visible directly in search results when someone searches for the practice. One post per week — a patient before/after (with consent), a team spotlight, an offer update, the Sunday-hours reminder — takes 15 minutes and signals to Google that the profile is active.

Add an email capture to the homepage: A simple "Join our patient community" opt-in with a whitening tip or new patient offer as the incentive. Email is the most direct, lowest-cost channel for recall and reactivation. Not having it means you're leaving the retention channel entirely to the appointment reminder system.

Effort: Medium

Other Things I Noticed

Thursday opens at 11 AM. Every other day starts at 9 AM. Thursday loses two hours of morning booking capacity. If this is a scheduling preference rather than a clinical necessity, it's worth revisiting — the morning block is a high-demand appointment window.

No live chat or AI receptionist. For a practice generating traffic across multiple services, a chat widget captures the visitor who doesn't want to call but has a quick question about insurance, wait times, or a specific procedure. It's a low-friction conversion tool that most Calgary SE competitors haven't deployed yet — a window for differentiation.

The Sunday-open advantage isn't being marketed. Galaxy Dental is closed Sundays. This fact should be on the homepage. It should be in the GBP description. It should be a GBP post category. "Dentist open Sunday Calgary SE" is a real search query that you can own — but you have to show up for it.

Free teeth whitening with new patient exams is a strong offer. If it's on the website but not in the GBP listing, not in Instagram bio, and not in paid search ads, it's underworking. An offer this clear and this tangible should be visible at every touchpoint where a patient is deciding whether to call.

Five-doctor practice with high-margin specialty depth. The service range — implants, Botox, laser dentistry, TMJ, sleep apnea, Invisalign — is genuinely broad. Each specialty should have a dedicated GBP service entry, a service page with local SEO optimization, and at least one recent social post. Right now that content infrastructure exists on the website but isn't being maintained actively.

How I'd Sequence the Fixes

This week

- Set up automated post-appointment review request (text/email) in your practice management system
- Update GBP service categories to include Cosmetic Dentist, Dental Implants Provider, Invisalign Provider
- Add Dr. Gill's Forttuna award to GBP description and homepage hero
- Add Sunday-hours callout to GBP description and homepage

Next 30 days

- Evaluate Jane App or equivalent real-time booking platform; begin integration
- Publish one blog post on a high-margin service (dental implants or Invisalign recommended first)
- Add Instagram bio update featuring the Forttuna award and Sunday availability
- Restart GBP post cadence (weekly)
- Designate a weekly review response owner — respond to every new review within 48 hours

30–90 days

- Launch real-time online booking; add booking CTAs across website and GBP profile
- Build out a content calendar: 1 blog/month, 1 GBP post/week, 3–4 Instagram posts/week
- Create a "Dentist of the Year" social post series featuring Dr. Gill's story and award context
- Add email capture with whitening offer to homepage; build basic welcome sequence for new subscribers
- Review Thursday hours — consider moving open time to 9 AM

Ongoing

- Monitor Google review count and velocity monthly (target: 8+ new reviews/month)
- Respond to every Google review, personalized
- Maintain GBP post cadence; update photos quarterly
- Track Maps pack presence for primary search terms every 90 days
- Feature Sunday availability in any paid search campaigns

The Next Step

Everything in this audit is yours to implement. The fixes are spelled out, in order of impact. Most practices won't get to them — not because they don't matter, but because there's never time. If you'd rather have someone run them for you, the Clarity Audit is the next step. We'll go deeper on the things that need it, prioritize against your specific goals, and give you a 90-day plan you can hand off. No pressure either way — the audit you're holding is the audit, not the appetizer.

[Book the Clarity Audit](#)

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